



ANDREW SANTANA instructs students on a high-tech newborn mannequin at Mt. San Antonio College.

JAMES BERNAL For the Hechinger Report

A crisis in care: Why nursing schools can't meet the demand

Oscar Mateo dreamed of being an artist, but after he contracted leukemia when he was 20, his life plans abruptly changed. The compassionate nursing care he received while hospitalized touched him so much that he decided he wanted to provide the same for others.

That goal led him to the registered nursing program at Mt. San Antonio College in Walnut. But getting there wasn't easy, as he had to battle competition for limited seats in one of the highest-demand fields in higher education, a career offering purpose, plentiful jobs and potentially six-figure paychecks.

Mateo was rejected three times by Mt. SAC before winning admission. To bur-

Lack of teachers and hands-on training slots keeps thousands from entering the field

By Teresa Watanabe

nish his resume, he earned certification as a nursing assistant and got work experience.

"It's so competitive and stressful," Mateo said. "It definitely takes a toll on you." Mateo represents a paradox bedeviling the U.S. nursing landscape. There is enormous demand for nurses as retirement or burnout push many from the field. But despite tens of thousands of students vying to get into nursing programs, schools can't accommodate the demand for two major reasons: They can't find enough faculty to teach classes and there is a dearth of required hands-on training opportunities in hospitals and healthcare facilities.

[See Nurses, A6]

Israel pits Gaza militias against Hamas

Netanyahu's government is empowering Palestinian clan groups that are accused of looting aid convoys

By NABIH BULOS



SAEED M.M.T. JARAS Anadolu

BELONGINGS piled high, a man in Gaza City is bound for the southern region.

For as long as there have been people in what is now California, the granite peaks of the Sierra Nevada have held masses of ice, according to new research that shows the glaciers have probably existed since the last Ice Age more than 11,000 years ago.

The remnants of these glaciers, which have already shrunk dramatically since the late 1800s, are retreating year after year, and are projected to melt completely this century as global temperatures continue to rise.

In a study published last week, scientists examined the distant past of some of the largest glaciers in the Sierra Nevada by chipping away pieces of bedrock near the edges of the ice and analyzing the rocks.

They found that at two large glaciers, one in Yosemite National Park and another bordering the park, the rocks have continuously been covered, most likely by ice, since the end of the last Ice Age. They also found that another smaller glacier, which has mostly melted, has probably existed for at least 7,000 years, longer than previously known.

California's glaciers are retreating

Ice-free peaks of Sierra Nevada have never been seen by humans

By Ian James



IAN JAMES Los Angeles Times

THE EAST LYELL glacier, shown in 2021, has lost an estimated 95% of its volume since the late 1800s.

"It means that when these glaciers die off, we will be the first humans to see ice-free peaks in Yosemite," said Andrew Jones, a researcher at the University of Wisconsin, Madison, who led the study.

The findings in the journal Science Advances indicate the Sierra's glaciers are older than suggested by previous research.

The study's authors, who also included scientists from other universities and the National Park Service, wrote that California's glaciers are thought to have reached their maximum extent about 30,000 years ago, and that the research indicates "a future glacier-free Sierra Nevada is unprecedented in human history" since people arrived in the Americas from Asia approximately 20,000 years ago.

Glaciers are rapidly shrinking around the world, from the Himalayas to the Andes, as temperatures are pushed higher by the use of fossil fuels and rising greenhouse gas levels.

Jones said many of the glaciers he and his col-

[See Glaciers, A6]

Newsom aims to stop Guard deployment

Governor says Trump sending California troops to Oregon is an abuse of power.

By DANIEL MILLER AND MELODY GUTIERREZ

Gov. Gavin Newsom said Sunday that he intends to seek a court order in an attempt to stop President Trump's deployment of California National Guard troops to Oregon.

Calling the president's action a "breathtaking abuse" of power, Newsom said in a statement that 300 California National Guard personnel were being deployed to Portland, a city the president has called "war-ravaged."

"They are on their way there now," Newsom said of the National Guard. "This is a breathtaking abuse of the

law and power."

Trump's move came a day after a federal judge in Oregon temporarily blocked the federalization of the state's National Guard. Constitutional law experts said the deployment of the California National Guard to Oregon without the consent of either state's governor is an obvious effort by the president to sidestep the judge's ruling on Saturday.

"This is a blatant attempt to circumvent Judge [Karin] Immergut's order," said Elizabeth Goitein, senior director of the Brennan Center's Liberty and National Security Program. "Her decision makes very clear that there is no lawful basis for deploying federalized National Guard troops in Oregon."

Such an action is without precedent, said Jessica Levinson, a law professor at Loyola Law School.

"I cannot think of a his-

[See Guard, A7]

Home insurer asks for 36% rate hike

FAIR Plan cites losses in January fires. State insurance chief will decide on increase.

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

The California FAIR Plan, the state's home insurer of last resort, is seeking an average 35.8% rate hike, its largest in years, following billions of dollars of losses incurred in the January firestorms.

The Los Angeles-based insurance pool, operated and backed by the state's licensed home insurers, filed last week for the dwelling policy rate hike, which must be reviewed and could be reduced by the state insurance commissioner.

"By statute, FAIR Plan rates must be sufficient to pay anticipated claims and expenses," FAIR Plan spokesperson Hilary McLean said in a statement. "The FAIR Plan is working closely with the California Department of Insurance to ensure its rates reflect the current risk portfolio, expenses and growth as the state's insurer of last resort."

The plan, which has added hundreds of thousands of policyholders in recent years as insurers have pulled back from the market amid rising wildfires, has estimated losses of \$4 billion from the January blazes. Those losses forced it to assess its member carriers \$1 billion in order to pay all claims.

The rate hike would hit individual homeowners unevenly, with many experi-

[See Insurance, A8]

A surrogacy mansion, a drug stash house and a guy called 'Dragon'

By MATTHEW ORMSETH AND SUMMER LIN

The first time El Monte police raided Pacific Place, a gated pink complex of office buildings and warehouses, they found an illicit casino.

Crammed inside a suite were electronic gambling tables with flashing lights, a detective wrote in a search warrant affidavit. Police seized the machines on Dec. 9, 2021, along with cash and several pounds of methamphetamine.

Police returned to the Valley Boulevard property and an adjoining building four more times in three years, search warrant affidavits show. They found

something different each time: Gambling parlor. Marijuana stash house. Psilocybin mushroom grow.

Then came the strangest discovery yet: When police searched the property owner's mansion in the neighboring city of Arcadia, they found 15 children, most of them toddlers.

Guojun Xuan, 65, told detectives he fathered 22 kids in all. All but two were born to surrogates, women who'd been paid to receive an embryo transfer and carry the children to term.

Kollin Ceadlo, a lieutenant for the Arcadia Police Department, said his detectives didn't know whether they'd stumbled

[See Mansion, A8]

Swift's turn from tortured to tailored

The pop star is sweeping away the mess of albums past in "The Life of a Showgirl." ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Attacks in Gaza on eve of talks

Israel and Hamas prepare for indirect ceasefire negotiations Monday in Egypt. WORLD, A3

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 77/60. B5

Opinion Voices A11
Obituaries B6

Chargers flogged by Commanders

Croskey-Merritt runs for 111 yards and two scores in 27-10 win for Washington. SPORTS, D8

For the latest news, go to latimes.com.

